

Leave & Time Off Policy

Northwind Traders, Inc. | Human Resources | Effective: January 1, 2026 | Version 4.2 | Policy Owner: VP, People Operations

1. Purpose & Scope

This policy explains the paid and unpaid leave benefits available to all regular full-time and part-time employees of Northwind Traders, Inc. (“the Company”). It applies to all U.S.-based employees unless a separate country- or state-specific addendum applies.

2. Types of Leave

2.1 Annual / Paid Time Off (PTO)

Full-time employees accrue PTO on a bi-weekly basis starting on their first day of employment. Part-time employees accrue PTO on a pro-rated basis according to scheduled hours.

Years of Service	Annual Accrual	Max Carryover	Accrual Cap
0 – 2 years	15 days	5 days	22.5 days
3 – 5 years	20 days	5 days	27.5 days
6 – 10 years	23 days	10 days	30 days
11+ years	25 days	10 days	32.5 days

2.2 Sick Leave

Employees receive 10 days of paid sick leave per calendar year, credited in full on January 1 (or on the employee's start date for new hires). Unused sick leave does not carry over and is not paid out upon separation.

2.3 Parental Leave

Eligible employees (90+ days of continuous service) receive 12 weeks of paid parental leave following the birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child. Parental leave may be taken continuously or intermittently within 12 months of the qualifying event, subject to manager approval for intermittent scheduling.

2.4 Bereavement Leave

Up to 5 paid days for the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, sibling) and up to 2 paid days for an extended family member.

2.5 Jury Duty & Civic Leave

The Company provides paid leave for jury duty and voting, consistent with state law. Employees must provide a copy of the jury summons to their manager and HR.

2.6 Company-Observed Holidays

- New Year's Day

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- Memorial Day
 - Juneteenth
 - Independence Day
 - Labor Day
 - Thanksgiving Day
 - Day after Thanksgiving
 - Christmas Eve
 - Christmas Day
 - New Year's Eve (half day)

3. Requesting Leave

PTO requests of 3 days or fewer should be submitted through the WorkdayHR portal at least 5 business days in advance. Requests of more than 3 consecutive days require 15 business days' notice and written manager approval. Approval is based on business needs and team coverage, and requests are addressed in the order received.

4. Unplanned Absences

Employees who are unexpectedly unable to work must notify their direct manager no later than the start of their scheduled shift, by phone or Slack. More than 3 unplanned absences in a rolling 90-day period may trigger a review under the Attendance Guidelines.

5. Leave Without Pay

Unpaid leave may be granted at the Company's discretion once an employee has exhausted all applicable paid leave balances, and requires VP-level approval. Benefits continuation during unpaid leave is addressed in the Benefits Guide.

6. Questions

Direct questions to the People Operations team at **people-ops@northwindtraders.example** or via the #ask-hr Slack channel.